

Chapter 2 — Vowel Identification Exercise

Hebrew Vowels — Identification and Classification

For each Hebrew form shown, identify: (1) Vowel Name, (2) Vowel Class (A / E / I / O / U / Reduced), (3) Quantity (Long / Short / Reduced), (4) Notes (e.g., mater lectionis present, composite sheva, dagesh forte). The letter ם (mem) serves as the carrier consonant for most items.

#	Form	Vowel Name	Class	Quantity	Notes
1	הַ				
✓	הַ	Qamets	A	Long	Standard long A; T-bar shape below consonant
2	הֶ				
✓	הֶ	Tsere	E	Long	Standard long E; two dots horizontally below consonant
3	הִ				
✓	הִ	Hireq	I	Short	Standard short I; single dot below consonant
4	הוֹ				
✓	הוֹ	Holem	O	Long	Long O; single dot above the letter to the upper left
5	הֻ				
✓	הֻ	Qibbutz	U	Short	Short U; three diagonal dots below consonant
(-) הֵ					
(-) הֵ	✓	Vocal Sheva	Reduced	Reduced	Vocal — word must begin with a vowel sound; /ə/
7	הָ				
✓	הָ	Patah	A	Short	Standard short A; horizontal bar below consonant
8	הֱ				
✓	הֱ	Seghol	E	Short	Standard short E; three dots (inverted triangle)
9	הֵי				
✓	הֵי	Hireq Yod	I	Long	Hireq with yod mater lectionis; yod is quiescent
10	הוֹי				
✓	הוֹי	Holem Vav	O	Long	Holem with vav mater lectionis; vav is quiescent
11	הוּי				
✓	הוּי	Shureq	U	Long	Long U; vav with a dot in its center; vav is mater
(-) הֵי					
(-) הֵי	✓	Silent Sheva	—	—	Silent — marks the close of the final syllable
13					
(,) הֵי	✓	Qamets Hatuf	O	Short	Same shape as Qamets; O-class in closed unaccented syllable
14	הֵי				
✓	הֵי	Tsere Yod	E	Long	Tsere with yod mater lectionis; yod is quiescent
15	הֵי				
✓	הֵי	Hireq Yod	I	Long	Long I with yod mater; dagesh lene in kaph; word = because/that
(=) הֵי					
(=) הֵי	✓	Qamets Hatuf	O	Short	O-class, short; same glyph as Qamets; closed unaccented syllable
17	הֵי				
✓	הֵי	Hatef Patah	A	Reduced	Composite sheva; A-class; used under gutturals
18	הֵי				